

# Cambridge IGCSE™

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**FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH****0500/23**

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

**May/June 2026****MARK SCHEME**Maximum Mark: 80

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**Published**

This mark scheme contains the instructions and marking guidance that our examiners used to mark candidate responses for this component.

Before they start marking, examiners complete a standardisation process. They review a range of candidate responses and discuss the mark scheme in detail to agree which answers can and cannot be accepted. Examiners award marks where it is clear that candidate responses have met the requirements of the mark scheme. These requirements may vary between different components or different versions of the same component, depending on the exact requirements of the question and the candidate responses seen during the standardisation process.

Sometimes, our mark schemes may allow marks to be awarded to responses which contain elements that are factually incorrect or for content not covered by the syllabus. We do this in response to the demands of a specific question to support candidates and make sure that our assessments are fair. However, these allowances should not be used as a guide for teaching and learning.

We cannot discuss the mark scheme with schools, and we recommend that schools read the mark scheme together with the assessment material and the Principal Examiner Report for Teachers.

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This document consists of **12** printed pages.

**General marking principles**

All examiners must apply these marking principles when marking candidate responses.

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Examiners must award marks for each response in line with: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>the specific <b>content</b> defined in the mark scheme</li> <li>the specific <b>skills</b> defined in the mark scheme or in the level descriptions</li> <li>the <b>standard of response</b> required as exemplified by the standardisation scripts.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 2 | Examiners must award <b>whole marks</b> (not half marks, or other fractions).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 3 | Examiners must award marks <b>positively</b> . This means that: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>marks are not deducted for errors or omissions</li> <li>marks are awarded for correct/valid answers as defined in the mark scheme and also for <b>other valid answers</b> which go beyond the scope of the syllabus and mark scheme referring to your team leader as appropriate</li> <li>the quality of spelling, punctuation and grammar are judged <b>only</b> when the mark scheme indicates that these features are <b>specifically assessed</b> in the question. However, the meaning of all responses must be unambiguous.</li> </ul> |
| 4 | Examiners must <b>consistently</b> apply the requirements of the mark scheme and any rules for what to do when candidates have not followed instructions correctly.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 5 | Examiners must use the <b>full range of marks</b> defined in the mark scheme, unless limited by the quality of the candidate responses seen.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 6 | Examiners must award marks according to the mark scheme and <b>must not</b> award marks with grade thresholds or grade descriptions in mind.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

**English & Media-Specific Marking Principles**

**(To be read in conjunction with the General Marking Principles (and requiring further guidance on how to place marks within levels))**

**Components using level descriptions:**

- We use level descriptions as a guide to broad understanding of the qualities normally expected of, or typical of, work in a level.
- Level descriptions are a means of general guidance and should not be interpreted as hurdle statements.
- Where indicative content notes are supplied for a question, these are *not* a prescription of required content and must not be treated as such. Alternative correct points and unexpected answers in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the knowledge and skills demonstrated.
- While we may have legitimate expectations as to the ground most answers may occupy, we must at all times be prepared to meet candidates on their chosen ground, provided it is relevant ground (e.g. clearly related to and derived from a relevant passage/text and meeting the mark scheme requirements for the question).

**Components using point-based marking:**

Point marking is often used to reward knowledge, understanding and application of skills. We give credit where the candidate's answer shows relevant knowledge, understanding and application of skills in answering the question. We do not give credit where the answer shows confusion.

From this it follows that we:

- DO credit answers which are worded differently from the mark scheme if they clearly convey the same meaning (unless the mark scheme requires a specific term).
- DO credit alternative answers/examples which are not written in the mark scheme if they are correct.
- DO credit answers where candidates give more than one correct answer in one prompt/numbered/scaffolded space where extended writing is required rather than list-type answers. For example, questions that require *n* reasons (e.g. State two reasons...).
- DO NOT credit answers simply for using a 'key term' unless that is all that is required. (Check for evidence it is understood and not used wrongly.)
- DO NOT credit answers which are obviously self-contradicting or trying to cover all possibilities.
- DO NOT give further credit for what is effectively repetition of a correct point already credited unless the language itself is being tested. This applies equally to 'mirror statements' (i.e. polluted/not polluted).
- DO NOT require spellings to be correct, unless this is part of the test. However, spellings of syllabus terms must allow for clear and unambiguous separation from other syllabus terms with which they may be confused (e.g. corrasion/corrosion).

**Annotations guidance for centres**

Examiners use a system of annotations as a shorthand for communicating their marking decisions to one another. Examiners are trained during the standardisation process on how and when to use annotations. The purpose of annotations is to inform the standardisation and monitoring processes and guide the supervising examiners when they are checking the work of examiners within their team. The meaning of annotations and how they are used is specific to each component and is understood by all examiners who mark the component.

We publish annotations in our mark schemes to help centres understand the annotations they may see on copies of scripts. Note that there may not be a direct correlation between the number of annotations on a script and the mark awarded. Similarly, the use of an annotation may not be an indication of the quality of the response.

The annotations listed below were available to examiners marking this component in this series.

**Annotations**

| Annotation                                                                          | Meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    | Used to indicate a development of ideas taken from the reading passage for question 1.                                                                                                                                  |
|    | Used to indicate an evaluation of the ideas in the reading passage for question 1.                                                                                                                                      |
|  | Used to indicate expression errors or, once examiners have been approved, to indicate all errors.                                                                                                                       |
|  | Used to indicate lifted material, where phrases or sections of the reading passage have been copied directly.                                                                                                           |
| Text box                                                                            | Used for summative comments at the end of each response. R and W, CS and SA as abbreviations for each mark. A level descriptor is used to write a comment for each which reflects the candidate's level of achievement. |
|  | Used to indicate apt selection of explicit ideas in question 1 responses, or sometimes to indicate effective images or vocabulary in the compositions.                                                                  |
|  | Used to indicate punctuation errors.                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|  | Used to indicate spelling or homophone errors.                                                                                                                                                                          |
|  | Used to indicate that all blank pages have been checked / viewed.                                                                                                                                                       |

**Note:** All Examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the passage.

## **Section A: Directed Writing**

### **Question 1**

This question tests the following writing assessment objectives (25 marks)

**W1** articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

**W2** organise and structure ideas and opinions for deliberate effect

**W3** use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context

**W4** use register appropriate to context

**W5** make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar

*and* reading assessment objectives (15 marks)

**R1** demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

**R2** demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

**R3** analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text

**R5** select and use information for specific purposes.

| Question | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Marks |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 1        | <p><b>A friend has decided to apply to become a student mentor at your school or college. You have some concerns about whether this is a good idea.</b></p> <p><b><u>Write a letter</u> to your friend, giving your views.</b></p> <p><b>In your letter you should:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• evaluate the benefits and challenges of mentoring given in both texts</li> <li>• share your concerns with your friend and the factors they need to consider before applying.</li> </ul> <p><b>Base your letter on what you have read in <u>both</u> texts, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.</b></p> <p><b>Write about 250 to 350 words.</b></p> <p><b>Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.</b></p> <p>Notes on task:<br/>Responses <b>might</b> use the following <b>explicit ideas</b>:</p> <p><b>Text A:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• being a mentor is popular/can build different skills/looks good on applications</li> <li>• can build mentee's confidence/is different from working with a teacher</li> <li>• limited evidence to show whether mentoring is effective</li> <li>• other mentorship models exist with adult mentors</li> <li>• student mentors are respected in schools / are identifiable to younger students</li> </ul> <p><b>Text B:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• mentors help with organisation skills</li> <li>• badges make mentors identifiable to all younger students in the school</li> <li>• mentors have good training/dedicated spaces and times</li> <li>• teachers value mentors' work / grant some leeway for mentors</li> <li>• employers / universities value skills learned by mentors</li> </ul> <p>Responses <b>might</b> evaluate the following <b>implicit ideas</b>:</p> <p><b>Benefits of being a mentor:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• can improve interpersonal skills/empathy/compassion</li> <li>• can boost self-confidence/develop leadership skills</li> <li>• can develop independence without teacher supervision</li> </ul> <p><b>Challenges/Concerns:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• can be very time-consuming, can encroach on mentors' family/free time</li> <li>• emotionally draining/exhausting dealing with mentees' personal issues</li> <li>• being available all the time can be overwhelming</li> <li>• you need the qualities of a role model all the time, difficult for young people to sustain</li> <li>• can jeopardise the mentor's own academic achievement</li> <li>• some younger students' problems can't be solved by another student</li> </ul> | 40    |

**Marking criteria for Section A Question 1****Table A, Writing**

Use the following table to give a mark out of 25 for writing.

| Level    | Marks        | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>6</b> | <b>22–25</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Highly effective style capable of conveying subtle meaning. (W1)</li> <li>Carefully structured for benefit of the reader. (W2)</li> <li>Wide range of sophisticated vocabulary, precisely used. (W3)</li> <li>Highly effective register for audience and purpose. (W4)</li> <li>Spelling, punctuation and grammar almost always accurate. (W5)</li> </ul>                                                     |
| <b>5</b> | <b>18–21</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Effective style. (W1)</li> <li>Secure overall structure, organised to help the reader. (W2)</li> <li>Wide range of vocabulary, used with some precision. (W3)</li> <li>Effective register for audience and purpose. (W4)</li> <li>Spelling, punctuation and grammar mostly accurate, with occasional minor errors. (W5)</li> </ul>                                                                            |
| <b>4</b> | <b>14–17</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Sometimes effective style. (W1)</li> <li>Ideas generally well sequenced. (W2)</li> <li>Range of vocabulary is adequate and sometimes effective. (W3)</li> <li>Sometimes effective register for audience and purpose. (W4)</li> <li>Spelling, punctuation and grammar generally accurate though with some errors. (W5)</li> </ul>                                                                              |
| <b>3</b> | <b>10–13</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Inconsistent style, expression sometimes awkward but meaning clear. (W1)</li> <li>Relies on the sequence of the original text. (W2)</li> <li>Vocabulary is simple, limited in range or reliant on the original text. (W3)</li> <li>Some awareness of an appropriate register for audience and purpose. (W4)</li> <li>Frequent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar, sometimes serious. (W5)</li> </ul> |
| <b>2</b> | <b>6–9</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Limited style. (W1)</li> <li>Response is not well sequenced. (W2)</li> <li>Limited vocabulary or words/phrases copied from the original text. (W3)</li> <li>Limited awareness of appropriate register for audience and purpose. (W4)</li> <li>Persistent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar. (W5)</li> </ul>                                                                                         |
| <b>1</b> | <b>1–5</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Expression unclear. (W1)</li> <li>Poor sequencing of ideas. (W2)</li> <li>Very limited vocabulary or copying from the original text. (W3)</li> <li>Very limited awareness of appropriate register for audience and purpose. (W4)</li> <li>Persistent errors in spelling, punctuation and grammar impede communication. (W5)</li> </ul>                                                                        |
| <b>0</b> | <b>0</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>No creditable content.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |



**Table B, Reading**

Use the following table to give a mark out of 15 for reading.

| Level    | Marks        | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>6</b> | <b>13–15</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Successfully evaluates ideas and opinions, both explicit and implicit. (R1, R2, R3)</li> <li>Assimilates ideas from the text to give a developed, sophisticated response. (R3, R5)</li> </ul>                   |
| <b>5</b> | <b>10–12</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Some successful evaluation of ideas and opinions, both explicit and implicit. (R1, R2, R3)</li> <li>A thorough response, supported by a detailed selection of relevant ideas from the text. (R3, R5)</li> </ul> |
| <b>4</b> | <b>7–9</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Begins to evaluate mainly explicit ideas and opinions. (R1, R2, R3)</li> <li>An appropriate response that includes relevant ideas from the text. (R3, R5)</li> </ul>                                            |
| <b>3</b> | <b>5–6</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Selects and comments on explicit ideas and opinions. (R1, R2, R3)</li> <li>Makes a general response including a few relevant ideas from the text. (R3, R5)</li> </ul>                                           |
| <b>2</b> | <b>3–4</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Identifies explicit ideas and opinions. (R1, R2, R3)</li> <li>Makes a limited response with little evidence from the text. (R3, R5)</li> </ul>                                                                  |
| <b>1</b> | <b>1–2</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Very limited response with minimal relation to the text. (R1, R2, R3, R5)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                            |
| <b>0</b> | <b>0</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>No creditable content.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                               |



**Section B: Composition****Questions 2, 3, 4, 5**

The question tests the following writing objectives (40 marks)

**W1** articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

**W2** organise and structure ideas and opinions for deliberate effect

**W3** use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context

**W4** use register appropriate to context

**W5** make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar.

| Question | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Marks |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 2        | <p><b>EITHER</b></p> <p><b>Describe what you saw, heard and felt when you were transported to a different time or place.</b></p> <p>Use Table A to give a mark out of 16 for content and structure and Table B to give a mark out of 24 for style and accuracy.</p> | 40    |

| Question | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Marks |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 3        | <p><b>EITHER</b></p> <p><b>Describe your first impressions of someone you later came to know well.</b></p> <p>Use Table A to give a mark out of 16 for content and structure and Table B to give a mark out of 24 for style and accuracy.</p> | 40    |

| Question | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Marks |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 4        | <p><b>EITHER</b></p> <p><b>Write a story which includes the words ... ‘they noticed something in the background ...’.</b></p> <p>Use Table A to give a mark out of 16 for content and structure and Table B to give a mark out of 24 for style and accuracy.</p> | 40    |

| Question | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Marks |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 5        | <p><b>EITHER</b></p> <p><b>Write a story with the title, ‘A different kind of family’.</b></p> <p>Use Table A to give a mark out of 16 for content and structure and Table B to give a mark out of 24 for style and accuracy.</p> | 40    |

## Marking criteria for Section B

Table A, Composition: Content and structure

| Level | Marks | General and specific marking criteria                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6     | 14–16 | <b>General</b>                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|       |       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Content is complex, engaging and effective. (W1)</li> <li>Structure is secure, well balanced and carefully managed for deliberate effect. (W2)</li> </ul> |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|       |       | <b>Specific – descriptive</b>                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Specific – narrative</b>                                                                                                                                                 |
|       |       | <i>Many well-defined and developed ideas and images create a convincing overall picture with varieties of focus.</i>                                                                             | <i>The plot is well-defined and strongly developed with features of fiction writing such as description, characterisation and effective climax, and convincing details.</i> |
| 5     | 11–13 | <b>General</b>                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|       |       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Content is developed, engaging and effective. (W1)</li> <li>Structure is well managed, with some choices made for deliberate effect. (W2)</li> </ul>      |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|       |       | <b>Specific – descriptive</b>                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Specific – narrative</b>                                                                                                                                                 |
|       |       | <i>Frequent, well-chosen images and details give a mostly convincing picture.</i>                                                                                                                | <i>The plot is defined and developed with features of fiction writing such as description, characterisation, climax and details.</i>                                        |
| 4     | 8–10  | <b>General</b>                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|       |       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Content is relevant with some development. (W1)</li> <li>Structure is competently managed. (W2)</li> </ul>                                                |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|       |       | <b>Specific – descriptive</b>                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Specific – narrative</b>                                                                                                                                                 |
|       |       | <i>A selection of relevant ideas, images and details, even where there is a tendency to write in a narrative style.</i>                                                                          | <i>The plot is relevant and cohesive, with some features such as characterisation and setting of scene.</i>                                                                 |
| 3     | 5–7   | <b>General</b>                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|       |       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Content is straightforward and briefly developed. (W1)</li> <li>Structure is mostly organised but may not always be effective. (W2)</li> </ul>            |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|       |       | <b>Specific – descriptive</b>                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Specific – narrative</b>                                                                                                                                                 |
|       |       | <i>The task is addressed with a series of relevant but straightforward details, which may be more typical of a narrative.</i>                                                                    | <i>The plot is straightforward, with limited use of the features of narrative writing.</i>                                                                                  |

| Level | Marks | General and specific marking criteria                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2     | 3–4   | <b>General</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Content is simple, and ideas and events may be limited. (W1)</li> <li>Structure is partially organised but limited in its effect. (W2)</li> </ul> |                                                                                                                                                                              |
|       |       | <b>Specific – descriptive</b><br><br>The recording of some relevant events with limited detail.                                                                                                         | <b>Specific – narrative</b><br><br>The plot is a simple narrative that may consist of events that are only partially linked and/or which are presented with partial clarity. |
| 1     | 1–2   | <b>General</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Content is occasionally relevant or clear. (W1)</li> <li>Structure is limited and ineffective. (W2)</li> </ul>                                    |                                                                                                                                                                              |
|       |       | <b>Specific – descriptive</b><br><br><i>The description is unclear and lacks detail.</i>                                                                                                                | <b>Specific – narrative</b><br><br><i>The plot and/or narrative lacks coherence.</i>                                                                                         |
| 0     | 0     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>No creditable content.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                              |

**Table B, Composition: Style and accuracy**

| Level    | Marks        | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>6</b> | <b>21–24</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Precise, well-chosen vocabulary and varied sentence structures, chosen for effect. (W3)</li> <li>Consistent well-chosen register suitable for the context. (W4)</li> <li>Spelling, punctuation and grammar almost always accurate. (W5)</li> </ul>                                 |
| <b>5</b> | <b>17–20</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Mostly precise vocabulary and a range of sentence structures mostly used for effect. (W3)</li> <li>Mostly consistent appropriate register suitable for the context. (W4)</li> <li>Spelling, punctuation and grammar mostly accurate, with occasional minor errors. (W5)</li> </ul> |
| <b>4</b> | <b>13–16</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Some precise vocabulary and a range of sentence structures sometimes used for effect. (W3)</li> <li>Some appropriate register for the context. (W4)</li> <li>Spelling, punctuation and grammar generally accurate, but with some errors. (W5)</li> </ul>                           |
| <b>3</b> | <b>9–12</b>  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Simple vocabulary and a range of straightforward sentence structures. (W3)</li> <li>Simple register with a general awareness of the context. (W4)</li> <li>Frequent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar, occasionally serious. (W5)</li> </ul>                             |
| <b>2</b> | <b>5–8</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Limited and/or imprecise vocabulary and sentence structures. (W3)</li> <li>Limited and/or imprecise register for the context. (W4)</li> <li>Persistent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar. (W5)</li> </ul>                                                                |
| <b>1</b> | <b>1–4</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Frequently imprecise vocabulary and sentence structures. (W3)</li> <li>Register demonstrates little or no sense of the context. (W4)</li> <li>Persistent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar impair communication. (W5)</li> </ul>                                         |
| <b>0</b> | <b>0</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>No creditable content.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |